

Week 09 Practice Arena 2 (Section O only) Instructions

Mark as done

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Purpose of this practice arena

- This Practice Arena is a structured space for Week 09 analytic practice in Section O.
- In Arena 2, you will analyse the **professional decision space** faced by the Digital Learning Infrastructure team in the PES scenario.
- You will examine how different investigative and interpretive approaches shape how institutional decision-makers understand the situation.
- Your posts are analytic artefacts (bounded pieces of analysis), not a conversation or debate.
- The goal is to practise analysing **professional judgement under constraint** without yet producing your own final judgement.

Analytic posture and stance for this Arena

Analytic posture: structural analysis of a professional decision space

Analytic stance: restrained, comparative, pre-judgement

You are practising how to:

- identify how professional actors choose how to investigate and interpret evidence,
- analyse structural pressures that shape professional judgement,
- compare different investigative strategies,
- recognise how institutional interpretation can change depending on how evidence is gathered and presented.

You are **not yet deciding what the infrastructure team should do**.

What this Arena is doing analytically

Arena 2 examines the **decision space available to the infrastructure team** when preparing its technical briefing for the Digital Learning Governance Committee.

Two structural forces shape this situation:

- Interpretive influence — technical experts help decision-makers understand complex systems.
- **Reputational risk** — experts may face scrutiny if their analysis later appears incomplete or overstated.

Arena 2 analyses how different investigative and interpretive strategies respond to these pressures. The goal is to understand the **structure of the decision space**, not to resolve it.

Participation expectations

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In this arena, you must complete:

1. **One analytic move** responding to one Arena 2 practice prompt. This analytic move must be posted as a **new thread**.
2. **One analytic response move** responding to a peer's analytic move within the same arena.

Each thread must represent **one analytic move only**.

Subject lines must follow this template exactly:

PPx – <short analytic description> - scenario

- PPx corresponds to the prompt number (e.g., PP3, PP4).
- <short analytic description> neutrally names the analytic focus.
- scenario indicates that the PES scenario is the primary source used.
- Do not include your name in the subject line.

Use only the materials listed under each practice prompt. Partial or provisional analysis is acceptable if it remains within scope.

Practice prompts for this Arena

Practice Prompt 1 (PP1) — Analysing investigative strategies

Consider the following investigative strategies available to the infrastructure team.

Evidence strategy ↓ / Interpretation posture →	Strong interpretation	Cautious interpretation
A1 — Report existing observations	Raise governance concerns based on limited evidence	Share operational observations without strong conclusions
A2a — Broad ecosystem review	Argue that system-wide patterns suggest a governance gap	Map the landscape of issues without asserting a firm conclusion
A2b — Focused investigation	Use detailed findings to support a specific governance concern	Clarify a technical issue while emphasising remaining uncertainty

Choose **one row** in the matrix (A1, A2a, or A2b).

Describe:

- what the infrastructure team would actually do under that investigative strategy,
- what kinds of evidence that strategy would likely produce,
- what kinds of institutional concerns the evidence might highlight.

You are analysing **how evidence is produced**, not whether the investigation is correct.

What analytic move this prompt is eliciting

Identify one investigative strategy and describe how it structures the evidence that the infrastructure team might produce. Explain what kinds of patterns, limitations, or insights the strategy might reveal. Keep the analysis descriptive and focused on how the investigative approach shapes what becomes visible to decision-makers.

Materials in scope for this prompt

- PES - Professional Scenario — Sections 1–5

Practice Prompt 2 (PP2) — Analysing interpretive posture

Consider the two interpretive approaches described below.

Strong interpretation

- present evidence as suggesting a governance concern.

Cautious interpretation

- present evidence while emphasising limits and uncertainty.

Choose **one investigative strategy** (A1, A2a, or A2b) and compare how the same evidence might be presented under the two [interpretive](#) postures.

Describe:

- how the infrastructure team might present the findings under a **strong interpretation**, and
- how the same findings might be presented under a **cautious interpretation**.

Focus on **how the presentation of evidence changes**, not on which interpretation is preferable.

What [analytic move](#) this prompt is eliciting

Analyse how the same evidence can be framed differently depending on how strongly the infrastructure team interprets its findings. Describe how [interpretive](#) choices shape how institutional decision-makers may understand the situation. Keep the analysis [descriptive](#) and avoid advocating for a specific interpretation.

Materials in scope for this prompt

- [PES - Professional Scenario](#) — Sections 1–5

How to practise your [analytic move](#)

- Choose **one** of the Arena 2 prompts.
- Write **150–250 words** performing **one clearly defined analytic action**.
- Post your [analytic move](#) as a **new thread** in the Arena 2 forum.
- Treat the thread as one bounded analytic artefact: make **one claim about how the professional decision space is structured**, supported by the scenario context.
- Use [descriptive](#) language: explain how evidence would be gathered, interpreted, or presented.
- Do not shift into professional judgement, institutional recommendations, advocacy, or debate.

The analytic response move: what you are practising

- Your response move is a second-order analytic action on a peer's [analytic move](#). It operates on the structure of their analysis, not on the topic itself. It is not agreement, disagreement, or debate.

Choose **one (and only one)** response action:

- clarify how the investigative strategy described by the peer would produce the evidence they identify,
- identify a limit or uncertainty that remains visible in the peer's analysis,
- explain how a different [interpretive](#) posture might present the same evidence differently,
- add one additional observation about how the scenario context may shape the evidence that becomes visible.

Keep your response move bounded and text-grounded. Do not introduce external cases or [evaluative](#) claims.

Participation window and deadlines

- Arena 2 occurs **after Arena 1** and builds on its analytic groundwork.
- Post your [analytic move](#) within the published participation window (note the grace periods).
- After the Arena 2 window closes, posting is no longer permitted.

How moderation works

- The teaching team's role is boundary-keeping, not conversation.
- You may see brief scope reminders, minimal corrections of scenario misreadings, and redirections if a post drifts out of bounds.
- You should not expect replies to every post, confirmation that an interpretation is "right," or extended dialogue.

Drift check and how to self-correct

Before posting, confirm:

- Am I analysing how evidence might be gathered or interpreted rather than deciding what should be done?
- Am I using only the scenario context and in-scope materials?
- Am I avoiding recommendations about what the university should do?
- Is this thread limited to one [analytic move](#)?

If you notice drift, restate your claim in [descriptive](#) terms and remove judgement-oriented language.

How this arena relates to other Week 09 artefacts

- Arena 2 builds on the [descriptive](#) interpretation developed in **Arena 1**.
- Arena 1 focused on **interpreting the technical environment and institutional concerns**.
- Arena 2 focuses on **how professionals decide how to investigate and interpret evidence** within that environment.
- This analytic work prepares you for later stages of the PES assignment, where you will develop and justify a professional judgement.
- Each post remains a bounded analytic artefact; the forum is not producing a single shared class position.

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